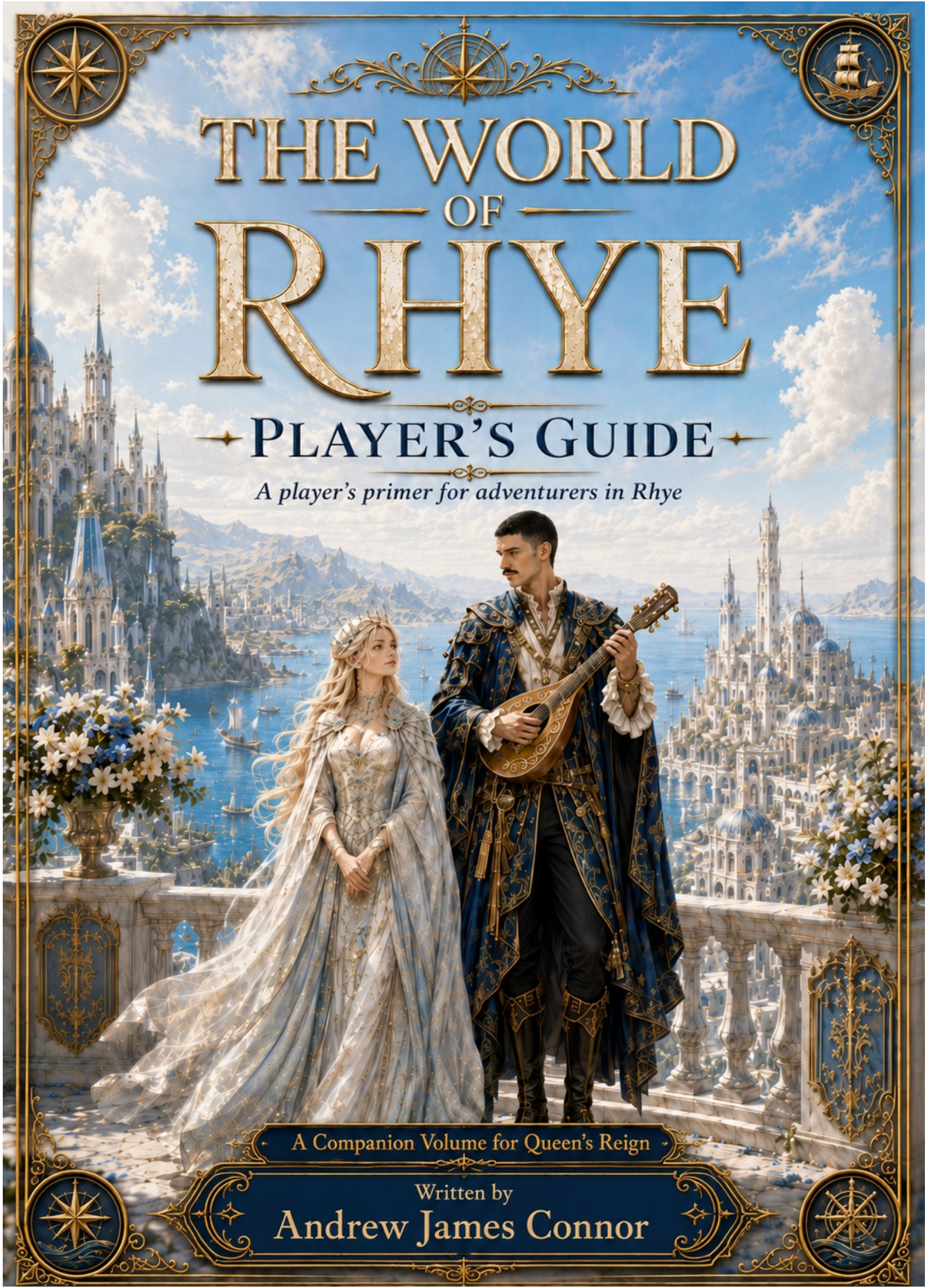




THE WORLD OF RHYE

PLAYER'S GUIDE

A player's primer for adventurers in Rhye

A Companion Volume for Queen's Reign

Written by

Andrew James Connor

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How to Use This Guide

This Player's Guide is for players before Session Zero, during character creation, and whenever they need a clear reminder of how Rhye feels at the table. It does not replace the campaign books or the World of Rhye setting guide. It presents the starting world as a beginning character, a local traveller, or a new adventurer would understand it.

What This Guide Gives You

This guide is your adventurer's first view of Rhye: history, local rumor, old songs, temples, roads, customs, character expectations, and the basic assumptions needed to begin play as a Level 1 adventurer.

Before You Begin

This guide gives you the starting knowledge, tone, character guidance, and long-term advancement rules your adventurer can bring into Session Zero. It presents Rhye as a beginning character would understand it: a real, lived-in world with history, law, roads, temples, and people worth protecting.

Marker	At the Table
⚖ Law	Authority, law, courts, Crown business, and reputation.
△ Magic	Magic, risk, prophecy, old language, and dangerous power.
▽ Travel	Travel, distance, roads, seas, inns, ports, and supplies.
△ Faith	Faith, temples, divine names, oaths, rites, and omens.
▽ Society	Society, culture, consequence, public memory, and the people who live under the Crown.

Use this guide to make characters who belong in Rhye, care about something inside it, and can work with other adventurers when the Crown, the roads, the gods, or people around them need help.

Welcome to Queen's Reign

Queen's Reign is a story-driven epic fantasy campaign set in Rhye, a vast land of old crowns, sea roads, ancient songs, careful law, and long memory. The campaign begins in late spring in the 939th Year of the Queen's Rule. The opening date is 19 May 939.

Rhye should first feel like a world that has been saved. Roads are safer than they once were. Coinage is reliable. Courts function. Ports trade. Villages know where to bring petitions. Temples keep rites. People can reasonably expect tomorrow to resemble today. That stability is part of what makes Rhye worth protecting.

Begin as someone who belongs in the world rather than someone standing above it. Ask questions, care about people, make choices, and let the road change your character over time.

Campaign Expectations

Characters

- Your character should be willing to travel with a group and take part in Crown business, even if they are not blindly loyal to the Crown.
- Your character does not need to begin as a perfect hero, but should be capable of growth, loyalty, cooperation, and moral pressure.
- Your character should have a reason to care about Rhye, a community, a faith, a family, a craft, a debt, or the chance to become something more than they are.
- Player-versus-player sabotage is not suitable for this campaign unless the whole table explicitly agrees to it before play.

Tone

Queen's Reign is not grimdark, and it is not a comedy campaign, though humor and strangeness both have a place in Rhye. It uses wonder, danger, politics, music, tragedy, mythic adventure, public consequence, and hard choices. Some victories will matter because a disaster was prevented, a witness was protected, or evidence reached the right people at the right time.

What Players Should Expect

- Milestone advancement rather than experience-point accounting.
- Investigation, social consequence, travel, politics, and combat all matter.
- Proof matters. In Rhye, a single witness who survives the journey can outweigh a chest of gold - and sometimes costs more.
- The party will often represent authority while also learning that authority has limits.
- The campaign is designed for long-term change from Level 1 through Level 30.

The World Does Not Need You

Most people in Rhye live and die without ever seeing the things your character may face. The Crown does not choose lightly, and the road does not wait for perfect heroes.

You said yes - or duty, debt, faith, family, hunger, or trouble left you standing where the call could find you.

Before Play Begins

Ask yourself two questions: what would make your character walk away, and what would make them stay? The answer does not need to be noble. It only needs to be true enough to survive the first hard choice.

Session Zero and Table Safety

Rhye includes difficult themes: inherited prejudice, legal servitude, political coercion, abuse of authority, religious fear, memory, death, grief, and institutions that do real good while also hiding harm. These themes should create meaningful consequence, not shock value.

- Discuss boundaries before play begins. Lines, veils, and pause tools are welcome at the table.
- Treat orc servitude as a system of oppression, not a joke, shorthand, or comic background detail.
- Characters can disagree strongly, but the group should remain playable together.
- A player who chooses a marginalized origin should receive story weight and agency, not be reduced to a single trait.
- No player should be forced to roleplay personal humiliation, torture, coercion, or prejudice beyond the table boundaries agreed in Session Zero.

Table Promise

The campaign asks characters to face flawed systems. It does not ask players to endure unsafe play. When a theme becomes too much, pause, adjust, and continue with trust intact.

The Player's View of Rhye

The world you know is called Rhye. It is a broad land surrounded by the Seven Seas and largely unified beneath the long reign of the Elven Queen. Most people alive today have never known a world without the Queen's peace.

This peace is real, but not perfect. Elves stand closest to the Crown. Humans in Brighton and the Human Lands often speak of elven arrogance. Gnomes, dwarves, and halflings mostly govern themselves and prefer to solve their own problems before asking the Crown for help. Orcs live under a harsh legal system officially called servitude, a subject many people avoid discussing plainly.

What Most Characters Know

Starting Knowledge	What It Means for Your Character
The Queen saved Rhye.	Most people are taught that the Elven Queen ended a terrible age and gave the world peace.
Dragons are extinct.	Dragons belong to history, old songs, statues, temple carvings, children's stories, and warnings from a long-ended age.
Necromancy is forbidden.	Raising the dead, creating undead, or tampering with souls is illegal and spiritually dangerous.
The gods have many names.	Elves usually use Greek names; humans often use Roman names. Both traditions honor the same divine beings.
The Crown works.	Roads, courts, coinage, ports, and governors are reliable enough that most households have reason to trust them.
The world is not fair.	The Queen's peace did not erase class, prejudice, servitude, regional resentment, or old grief.

The Shape of the World

Rhye is a continent-scale landmass defined by the Seven Seas of Rhye. Travel has weight here: a journey from Thor Rûn to Brighton is not an afternoon ride, but an expedition through roads, fields, inns, toll houses, river crossings, coast routes, and local authorities.

Sea	Player-facing place in the world
North Sea	Cold northern exterior sea, watched by routes toward the Great Glacier.
East Sea	Eastern exterior sea, distinct from the Great Glass Sea and its desert basin.
West Sea	Western exterior sea touching old forests, western hills, and exploratory routes.

Sea	Player-facing place in the world
Great South Sea	Broad southern sea of long routes, storms, distant sails, and final horizons.
Great Inland Sea	Interior water near Thor Rûn and the elven heartlands.
Inlet Sea	Brighton's sea: trade, docks, practical ships, fishing, shipbuilding, and human ambition.
Great Glass Sea	A vast flat inland sea of cooled glass, known across Rhye as the scar of an ancient catastrophe.

Travel and Scale

A map in Rhye is not decoration. Roads, seas, ports, toll houses, and inns decide who arrives in time, who can carry proof, and who gets left behind. A character who knows routes, trade, ship crews, temple calendars, or local customs can be just as useful as a character with a rare spell.

The Elven Queen and the White Crown

The current year is 939 of the Elven Queen's reign. Among elves, she is beloved, almost revered, and remembered as the savior who made the world safe. Humans tend to be more practical: the Queen ended a terrible age and brought peace and prosperity, and so her rule is accepted as deserved.

Most people experience the Queen's rule indirectly through governors, magistrates, councils, soldiers, roads, taxes, courts, temples, and the quiet confidence that the Crown still stands. The White Crown is not only a palace; it is a promise that monsters, bandits, warlords, and lawlessness will not be allowed to define ordinary life for long.

People	Common player-facing view of the Queen
Elves	Beloved savior, rightful ruler, living symbol of destiny and order.
Humans	A ruler whose actions earned the throne and made trade, law, and roads reliable.
Dwarves	Useful royal order, but not older than stone, oath, clan, or craft memory.
Gnomes	Stable enough to trade with, but not always quick enough to understand consequences of invention.
Halflings	A distant peace that keeps roads open, but village memory and guest-right still matter first.
Orcs and half-orcs	The face of a law that may not have been built to protect them.

⚔️ Agents of the White Crown

Early in the campaign, the party is drawn into service as the Queen's Agents, formally titled Agents of the White Crown. This is rare. People may react with respect, curiosity, caution, fear, or opportunism depending on where the party is and how they behave.

The Queen's seal is a white-and-silver token bearing a white crown above seven silver waves. When the characters act on Crown business, the seal can secure food, lodging, reasonable supplies, and legal assistance through merchant houses reimbursed by the Crown. It is a privilege, not a license.

The Seal Can	The Seal Cannot
Open doors when the party acts on legitimate Crown business.	Excuse cruelty, theft, bullying, needless violence, or personal enrichment.
Secure basic food, lodging, supplies, and legal help through approved channels.	Force every local authority to obey every request instantly.
Make witnesses more willing to speak when they trust the Crown.	Make frightened people feel safe if the party behaves like tyrants.
Identify the party as rare royal representatives.	Prevent consequences if the party abuses authority.

Table Expectation	Likely Result
Use the Seal with restraint and clear purpose.	The DM may grant advantage on reasonable Charisma checks with officials, guards, clerks, and lawful institutions.
Use authority to bully, threaten, enrich yourself, or silence people.	Expect disadvantage, refusal, witness fear, and lasting reputation damage.
Repeat serious abuse of Crown privilege.	The party may lose privileges, face legal consequences, or be treated as a liability rather than trusted Agents.

How to Play Crown Authority

Use authority to protect witnesses, preserve evidence, calm panic, and move the story forward. The strongest Agents of the White Crown are not the loudest. They are the ones people can trust when the room is afraid.

▽ Peoples and Character Origins

The following guidance is for starting characters. It describes how common an origin is in Rhye and what social weight it may carry. Any unusual origin should be discussed with the DM before play begins.

People / Origin	Availability	Player-facing guidance
Human	Predominant	Common across Brighton, the Human Lands, roads, ports, villages, and mixed settlements. Human characters often understand practical trade, work, compromise, and resentment of elven superiority.
Elf	Predominant	Common in Thor Rûn and closest to the Crown. Elven characters may begin with beauty, privilege, expectation, education, and pressure to honour inherited history.
Dwarf	Uncommon in big cities	Usually tied to clan-governed holds, craft memory, oath, stonework, and older records. Dwarves can challenge easy royal assumptions.
Gnome	Uncommon in big cities	Often self-governed through rotating First Speakers. Good for inventors, problem-solvers, civic tinkers, and characters whose cleverness has social consequences.
Halfling	Uncommon in big cities	Often elder-led and guest-right focused. Good for characters tied to hospitality, ordinary memory, family, food, songs, and small communities that remember more than they announce.
Goliath	Rare	Most likely around Brighton, harsh travel routes, coastal labor, frontier work, or difficult mountain roads. Rare, but workable.
Half-elf	Almost nonexistent	Usually requires a special explanation, intervention, protection, or unusual compatibility. Best used for bridge-identity and social category tension.
Half-orc	Playable with table care	Playable, but socially difficult. Half-orcs are treated as lower class in many places and may be assumed to be servants. This should be handled with consent and respect.
Aasimar	Extremely rare	Allowed only with DM approval. They require special table handling because divine meaning matters in Rhye.
Tiefling	Extremely rare	Allowed only with DM approval. They require special table handling because infernal, divine, or old-world meanings matter in Rhye.
Dragonborn	Not available	Dragonborn do not exist as a normal people of Rhye and are not a player option.
Orc	Not available as a starting PC	Orcs are not playable in this campaign. Their legal status is part of Rhye's hard-theme material, not a casual character option.
Drow / Avariel / other rare peoples	DM approval only	Not appropriate as ordinary starting choices unless the DM has a specific reason.

Character Creation Guidance

Good Fits

- A would-be hero answering the call of adventure.
- A practical traveler who wants steady work and a chance at advancement.
- A scholar, priest, soldier, bard, scout, artisan, healer, messenger, sailor, guard, or odd wanderer drawn into Crown service.
- A character from Thor Rûn, Brighton, a Crownlands village, the Human Lands, a gnomish enclave, a dwarven clan, a halfling community, or a road-worn place between them.
- A character who begins loyal to the Queen, skeptical of the Crown, indifferent to politics, or personally conflicted - as long as they can still adventure with the party.

Things to Avoid at Character Creation

- A character whose main goal is to betray the party.
- A character who refuses all Crown involvement from the start.
- A concept that requires special setting exceptions or knowledge not approved by the DM.
- A necromancer, undead cultist, or open servant of forbidden death magic.
- A lone-wolf concept that cannot accept help, trust, loyalty, or shared consequences.
- A character built to mock or trivialize oppression, faith, trauma, grief, or servitude.

Class and Background Notes

Character Type	Why it fits Rhye
Bards	Songs, stories, road memory, public performance, and fate all matter.
Clerics and Paladins	Temples, divine names, oaths, proper endings, and moral authority are central to Rhye.
Fighters, Rangers, Rogues, and Monks	Travel, protection, investigation, scouting, discipline, and decisive action matter at every tier.
Wizards, Sorcerers, Warlocks, and Artificer-like concepts	Magic is powerful, but meaning, source, consequence, and public trust matter. Discuss unusual patrons or forbidden magic with the DM.
Nobles and officials	Authority can open doors, but it also draws attention and responsibility.
Commoners, artisans, sailors, farmers, and merchants	Queen's Reign works best when ordinary life matters. Practical characters belong here.

Party Anchor

A Queen's Reign character can be stubborn, frightened, ambitious, proud, wounded, or skeptical. The important question is not whether they always agree with the group. It is why they will still stand with the group when the road becomes difficult.

Places Your Character May Know

Place	Player-facing texture
Thor Rûn	The elven capital and seat of the White Crown: white stone, silver banners, water channels, impossible order, public grace, and private condescension.
Brighton	The human capital: loud harbor, counting houses, shipyards, textile warehouses, fish markets, spice ledgers, practical pride, and commercial confidence.
Crownlands Villages	Safe roads, petitions, Crown-backed services, working courts, harvest records, and quiet dependence on Thor Rûn.
Human Lands	Rougher roads, local councils, markets, inns, trade caravans, hard bargains, and independence that is cultural before it is legal.
Gnomish Enclaves	Workshops, rotating First Speakers, clever infrastructure, and a strong habit of solving problems before asking the Crown.
Dwarven Holds	Clan halls, craft memory, stone agreements, old grudges, and oaths that outlast royal fashion.
Halfling Communities	Elder-led villages, guest-right, family memory, food, songs, and ordinary kindness with deep roots.
Arboria and Fey Borders	Old woods, bargain-language, seasonal law, and stories that make travelers careful with promises.
Great Glass Sea	A vast glittering glass desert known as the result of an ancient catastrophe and treated with awe, caution, and old sorrow.
Road Inns and Sea Routes	The connective tissue of Rhye. Inns, ferries, docks, toll houses, couriers, and caravans make the campaign feel lived in.

⚖️ Law, Courts, Coinage, and Daily Life

Rhye feels stable because its systems usually work. Coinage is reliable. Contracts matter. Roads are patrolled. Magistrates hear disputes. Temples perform rites. Merchant houses can extend credit. Governors answer local needs, even if slowly. This gives players a world where people can reasonably expect law to exist before the party arrives.

Everyday Institution	What players can assume at the start
Coinage	Common currency and merchant credit are reliable enough for trade and travel.
Courts	Magistrates hear disputes. Serious crimes are not ignored in settled lands.
Temples	Temples handle rites, faith, burials, holy days, and divine counsel. They do not normally replace civil law.
Governors	Regional governors handle local administration and communicate with the Crown.
City councils	Cities can manage local concerns but cannot directly contradict Crown authority.
Roads and inns	Major roads are safer than most fantasy worlds, but not safe enough to make heroes unnecessary.
The Auric House / Coin-House	A respected financial institution. Most people know it as a place of credit, ledgers, money, and formal trust.

Evidence Matters

When the party gathers proof, they are doing more than collecting details. A signed note can open a court. A frightened witness can move a governor. A relic carried safely from one town to the next can change what people are willing to believe.

Orc Servitude and Hard-Theme Play

Orc servitude is the official legal term for a harsh system that everyone knows is servitude in practice. It is more common in elven lands and less common in Brighton, but the problem exists across Rhye's political order. This is not a joke, a background gag, or a reason to treat a player character as disposable.

Half-orc characters are playable only with care. They are often treated as lower class and may be assumed to be servants. A half-orc player character should have agency, goals, dignity, and table protection. Use this origin to explore a difficult world, not to make the player endure constant humiliation.

Playing With Consent

Discuss how often prejudice appears on screen, what language is off limits, who is allowed to challenge it, and how the table will protect player agency. The goal is meaningful consequence, not misery.

Δ Gods, Temples, and Divine Names

The people of Rhye worship a shared pantheon through different cultural names. Elves commonly use Greek names, while humans more often use Roman names. Both names refer to the same divine beings. A temple of Hermes and a temple of Mercury may use different language and custom, but they honor the same god.

Choosing a Divine Relationship

Do not choose a god as a label. Choose what your character asks for - and what they fear receiving. In Rhye, gods answer in ways that make sense to them, not always in ways that make life easier for you.

Greek Name	Roman Name	Common Concerns
Zeus	Jupiter	Sky, storms, kingship, judgement
Hera	Juno	Marriage, sovereignty, dynastic dignity
Poseidon	Neptune	Sea, storms, horses, coastal power
Hades	Pluto	Dead, underworld wealth, sealed kingdoms
Athena	Minerva	Wisdom, strategy, civic order, craft
Ares	Mars	War, violence, battlefield courage
Aphrodite	Venus	Love, beauty, desire
Apollo	Apollo	Sun, music, prophecy, healing
Artemis	Diana	Moon, hunting, wild protection
Hermes	Mercury	Messages, roads, music, motion
Hephaestus	Vulcan	Forge, craft, hammer, divine injury
Thanatos	Mors	Death, endings, forbidden continuation
Hypnos	Somnus	Sleep, dreams, enchanted stillness
Nike	Victoria	Victory, triumph, public legend
Tyche	Fortuna	Luck, sudden reversals, public fate
Nemesis	Nemesis	Retribution, consequence, pride brought low
Nyx	Nox	Night, secrecy, powers older than temple order
Hestia	Vesta	Hearth, home, sanctuary
Dionysus	Bacchus	Wine, revelry, theatre, ecstatic truth
Demeter	Ceres	Harvest, fertility, seasons

Clerics, Paladins, and Divine Characters

- Choose a deity because your character has a relationship to that domain, not because it is the strongest mechanical option.
- Elven characters usually know Greek divine names first; human characters usually know Roman names first; mixed communities may use both.
- Divine magic exists in a world of rites, omens, temple authority, unanswered questions, and moral consequence.

- If your character serves death, endings, prophecy, fate, fire, or roads, discuss boundaries and expectations with the DM before play.

Δ Magic, Prophecy, and Forbidden Necromancy

Magic is part of Rhye, but it is not wallpaper. A spell cast in the wrong room can become a legal problem, a temple argument, a family scandal, or the first story someone tells about you years later. Old languages, prophecies, public miracles, and temple rites are treated with care because they can affect law, faith, politics, and ordinary lives.

Necromancy

Necromancy is forbidden. Raising the dead, creating undead, or tampering with souls is illegal and spiritually dangerous. A character built around necromantic practice is not appropriate for the opening campaign unless the DM specifically allows a very unusual story.

Prophecy and Memory

Characters may encounter old songs, strange omens, dreams, repeated phrases, unfamiliar inscriptions, and local customs. Treat these as invitations to pay attention, ask questions, and care about the people affected by them. Queen's Reign rewards curiosity, compassion, and thoughtful play.

▽ Travel, Equipment, and Player Assumptions

Assumption	Player guidance
Treasure is not the main engine.	Characters gain influence, proof, titles, allies, relics, access, and world-changing consequences more often than piles of loot.
Milestones drive advancement.	The party levels when the story reaches a meaningful campaign threshold.
Rest and safety are story tools.	Inns, temples, roads, homes, ships, and camps matter because Rhye is worth protecting.
Ordinary tools matter.	Rope, carts, ledgers, local contacts, letters, witness names, ritual notes, and maps can solve problems. Bring the humble thing; it becomes important when comfort runs out.
Reputation follows you.	How the party treats witnesses, officials, servants, enemies, and local people will return later.
Deliberate care is powerful.	Healing, calming crowds, preserving evidence, and choosing restraint can matter as much as damage.

A Road Journey in Play

A journey from Brighton to Thor Rûn might include two road tolls, three inns of varying quality, one river crossing, a magistrate checkpoint, and at least one story that was not true when you heard it.

Milestone Advancement

Queen's Reign uses milestone advancement. Characters advance because they resolve meaningful goals, change their standing in the world, and alter the future of Rhye. The DM will tell the group when a milestone is reached.

Campaign Tier	Levels	Player-facing focus
Opening Crown Service	1-5	The party becomes a group, receives authority, protects people, and learns how Crown service works.
Wider Roads and Responsibilities	6-10	The party travels farther, handles larger problems, and learns how different parts of Rhye respond to danger.
Greater Power and Public Consequence	11-15	The party handles more complex choices, stronger magic, broader reputation, and consequences that reach beyond one town.
High-Level Consequences	16-20	The party becomes known across Rhye, faces stronger opposition, and carries greater responsibility for the outcomes of their choices.
Epic Campaign Play	21-25	The party operates at mythic scale, with choices that can affect cities, temples, rulers, alliances, and the future of Rhye.
Final Epic Play	26-30	The party reaches the highest tier of the campaign, where their deeds help determine what kind of future Rhye receives.

Levels 21-30 Epic Progression

At Epic Levels, You Become Known

Beyond Level 20, people do not ask what you can do. They ask what you have already done. Your presence shapes outcomes before the first word is spoken. Kings prepare. Temples take notice. Cities remember your name. At the table, recognition begins to replace introduction: reputation may change the baseline of a social scene before any roll is made. Power at this level is not only mechanical - it is public.

From Levels 21-30, Queen's Reign remains milestone-based. Characters do not earn XP for epic levels. A new level is awarded when the party completes a major epic milestone, as determined by the DM.

Epic Mechanical Chassis

At each level beyond 20, characters gain hit points as though taking another level in their primary class. Proficiency bonus remains +6. Spellcasters do not gain spell slots above 9th level. Levels 21, 23, 25, 27, and 29 grant an epic boon. Levels 22, 24, 26, 28, and 30 grant either +2 to one ability score, +1 to two ability scores, or one approved epic-tier feat. Ability score maximums are usually capped at 22 unless a campaign-specific boon says otherwise.

Level	Character Benefit	Mechanical note
21	Epic boon	Gain one DM-approved epic boon tied to the character's deeds.
22	ASI or approved epic-tier feat	Gain an ability score improvement or one DM-approved epic-tier feat.
23	Epic boon	Gain one DM-approved epic boon tied to the character's deeds.
24	ASI or approved epic-tier feat	Gain an ability score improvement or one DM-approved epic-tier feat.
25	Epic boon	Gain one DM-approved epic boon tied to the character's deeds.
26	ASI or approved epic-tier feat	Gain an ability score improvement or one DM-approved epic-tier feat.
27	Epic boon	Gain one DM-approved epic boon tied to the character's deeds.
28	ASI or approved epic-tier feat	Gain an ability score improvement or one DM-approved epic-tier feat.
29	Epic boon	Gain one DM-approved epic boon tied to the character's deeds.
30	ASI or approved epic-tier feat	Gain an ability score improvement or one DM-approved epic-tier feat.

Epic boons should be tied to what the character has done in play. The DM chooses or approves each boon so it reflects the campaign, the character's choices, and the tone of the table.

Maps for Players

Most people in Rhye know the world through practical maps: an inn-wall route chart, a harbourmaster's tide board, a temple road-list, a schoolroom atlas, a merchant ledger, or a traveller's sketch folded into a pack. A new adventurer does not need to know every road or every ruler. It is enough to know the names people use, the seas that shape travel, and the difference between a place you have visited and a place you have only heard about.

Use the maps to help decide where your character comes from, what kind of places they have seen, and what parts of Rhye still feel distant, grand, or intimidating. A character from Thor Rûn may picture Brighton as loud and practical. A character from Brighton may imagine Thor Rûn as elegant, formal, and distant. A village-born character may know both cities mostly from coins, prayers, songs, road stories, and travellers passing through.

Using the Map at Session Zero

Choose one place your character knows well, one place they have heard about but never visited, and one road, sea, temple, market, inn, or family connection that gives them a reason to step into the wider world.





Character Creation Worksheet

Use these prompts before Session Zero or during character creation. A good answer can be one sentence.

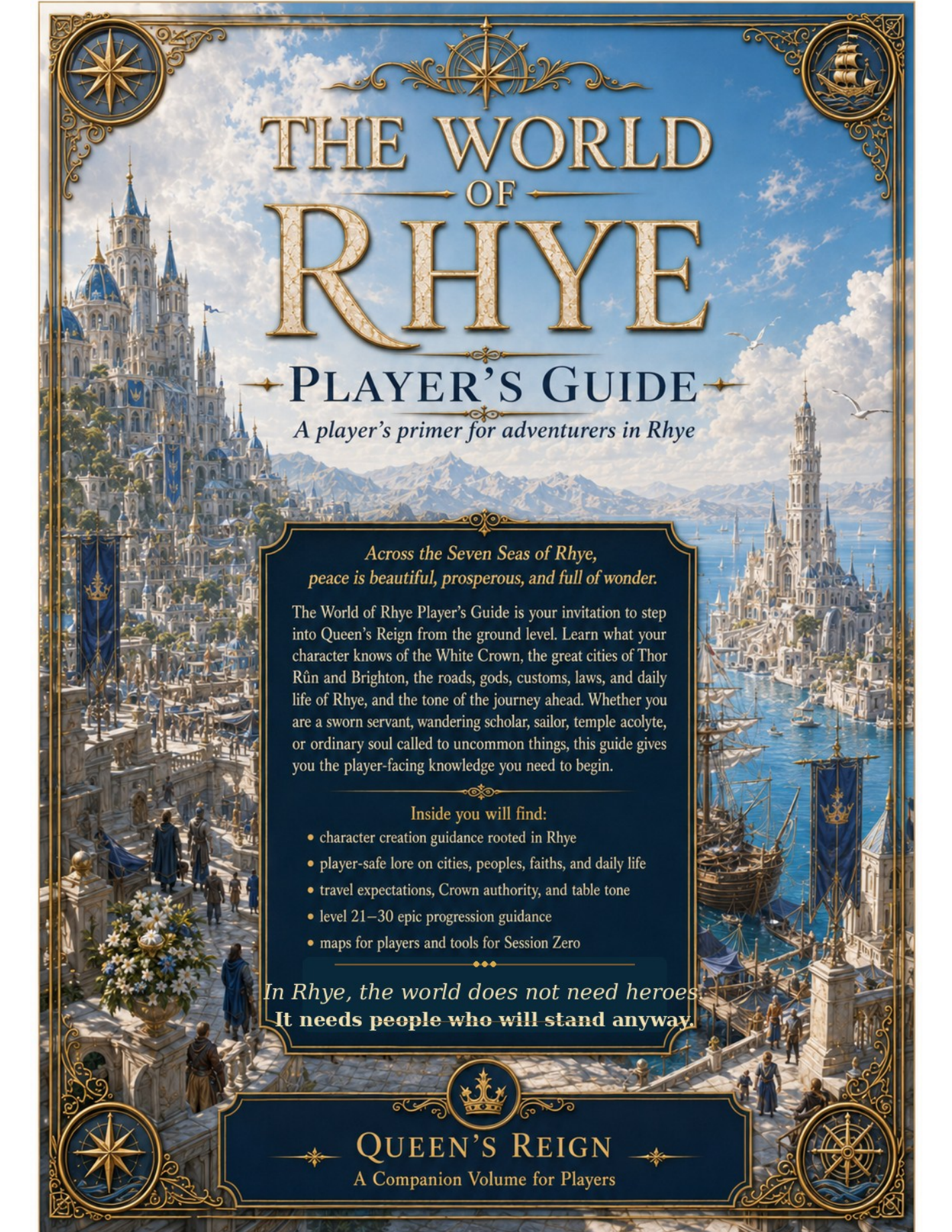
Prompt	Answer space / guidance
Where are you from?	Thor Rûn, Brighton, a village, a port, a road inn, a clan, an enclave, a temple, or somewhere stranger with DM approval.
Why did you answer the call?	Duty, debt, curiosity, ambition, faith, family, money, reputation, trouble, or a need to become more than ordinary.
What do you care about in Rhye?	A person, a town, a road, a temple, a craft, a ship, a family name, a song, a wrong, or an ideal.
How do you feel about the Queen?	Loyal, grateful, skeptical, proud, fearful, practical, indifferent, or conflicted.
What ordinary skill do you bring?	A trade, language, route, ledger habit, social custom, prayer, cooking, mending, sailing, scouting, or local knowledge.
What line will you not cross?	A moral boundary that helps the DM put pressure on the character without breaking player trust.
Who might recognize you?	A former employer, sibling, creditor, teacher, rival, priest, captain, old friend, or local official.
What would change you?	Power, failure, mercy, grief, public attention, proof of injustice, divine contact, love, or responsibility.
Why will you stay with the group when things go wrong?	Duty, friendship, shared danger, debt, oath, practical need, curiosity, guilt, loyalty, or the knowledge that walking away would cost someone else too much.

Quick Reference and Glossary

Term	Player-facing meaning
Agents of the White Crown	The formal title for the party when acting under the Queen's seal.
Auric House / Coin-House	A respected financial institution associated with credit, ledgers, coinage, and merchant trust.
Brighton	The human capital: mercantile, practical, loud, independent, and commercially powerful.
Crownlands	Regions closest to Thor Rûn and most dependent on the Queen's order.
Great Glass Sea	A flat glass desert known across Rhye as the result of an ancient catastrophe.
Necromancy	Forbidden magic involving undead, soul tampering, or improper continuation beyond death.
Rhye	The campaign world and continent-scale land surrounded by the Seven Seas.
Servitude	The official legal term for orc slavery under Crown law.
Seven Seas	The seas that define Rhye: North, East, West, Great South, Great Inland, Inlet, and Great Glass.
Thor Rûn	The elven capital and seat of the White Crown.
White Crown	The Queen's royal authority, symbol, government, and stabilizing order.

A Final Word for Players

The best characters for Queen's Reign are curious, grounded, and willing to care. Ask questions. Protect people. Listen to songs, roads, temples, inns, cities, courts, ruins, and ordinary witnesses. Begin as someone who belongs in Rhye. The rest will be decided by what you choose to protect.



THE WORLD OF RHYE

PLAYER'S GUIDE

A player's primer for adventurers in Rhye

*Across the Seven Seas of Rhye,
peace is beautiful, prosperous, and full of wonder.*

The World of Rhye Player's Guide is your invitation to step into Queen's Reign from the ground level. Learn what your character knows of the White Crown, the great cities of Thor Rûn and Brighton, the roads, gods, customs, laws, and daily life of Rhye, and the tone of the journey ahead. Whether you are a sworn servant, wandering scholar, sailor, temple acolyte, or ordinary soul called to uncommon things, this guide gives you the player-facing knowledge you need to begin.

Inside you will find:

- character creation guidance rooted in Rhye
- player-safe lore on cities, peoples, faiths, and daily life
- travel expectations, Crown authority, and table tone
- level 21–30 epic progression guidance
- maps for players and tools for Session Zero

*In Rhye, the world does not need heroes.
It needs people who will stand anyway.*

QUEEN'S REIGN

A Companion Volume for Players